INTERNAL · YOUR NOTES · NOT FOR ALLIED

Pitch Playbook

The three documents do the explaining. This is what you say, in what order, and what to do when it goes sideways.

Do not hand this one over

It names your own soft spots on purpose and it has demo logins in it. The three documents are the ones that leave your hands.

The 30-second version

> *“Every order we take costs about two hours of somebody's day — reading it, keying it into Sage, working out who supplies what, raising the POs, finding the mill certs, updating the board. I built something that does all of that in a fraction of a second and hands you a five-minute review instead.*
>
> *And while it is doing that, it checks every supplier bill against the order we actually raised — line by line, freight included. We do not do that today. That is where the money is.*
>
> *It is built and tested. Six thousand to connect it. At ten orders a week it pays for itself in ten weeks.”*

Then stop talking. The silence is doing work. Let them ask the next question.

> **Why that matters:** Whoever speaks next concedes something. If you keep going you will start listing features, which moves the room from “is this worth doing” to “what exactly does it do” — a worse conversation for you, because it has no end and no decision in it.

The four numbers, in this order

2 hrs **becomes 5 minutes**, per order. Say this one first — it is the only number everyone in the room can check against their own experience.

10 wks **to pay back the $6,000** at ten orders a week, five weeks at twenty. This is the number that makes it a small decision.

Every **supplier bill checked**, line by line, freight included. Does not happen today. This is the one to slow down on.

94% **of the busy work can go.** Connecting it gets 88% — supplier bills are already checked the moment they are read. Two small pieces get the rest, in about a week.

If you only get one sentence out

"Allied is a brokerage — the margin is the gap between what we buy at and what we sell at, so a dollar a supplier overbills does not come off that invoice, it comes off the only thing we actually sell."

Why that matters: Time savings are easy to explain and just as easy to wave away — everybody in that room has heard "this will save you time" before and watched it not happen. Nobody has heard the margin point, because it is specific to how Allied makes money. It is the sentence they repeat to someone else after you leave, which is the only sentence that really matters.

Selling the rate, if it comes up

Do not get defensive about $95. Reframe it — the comparison in their head is the wrong one.

> *"A consultancy would charge $150 an hour and send somebody who has never met any of you. A freelancer off a website would charge half and be on another contract by March. I am neither. I know who is in this business and what everybody actually does with their day, which is why the thing is built the way it is — and I am still going to be here when something looks odd on a Tuesday afternoon."*

If they push harder, the honest version lands better than a discount:

> *"Honestly? If this works, Allied runs better and everyone knows I built it. If it does not, I am still sat here and everyone knows that too. That is a stronger guarantee than anything you would get in a support contract."*

> **Why that matters:** Naming your own stake out loud sounds risky and is the opposite. Every outside vendor is implicitly asking Allied to trust a stranger's goodwill. You are the only option where the incentives are visible and permanent, so say it — it is the one advantage that cannot be matched at any price.

The question you will definitely get

“What is the catch?” Answer it before they ask it, if you can.

> *“Two. First, Sage 50 has no proper way for outside software to write into it unless you are on the desktop version. If you are on the online one, the system makes the import files and somebody clicks import — still removes all the typing, just not the last click. I can check which you have in about a minute, before anyone commits to anything.*
>
> *Second, the two-hour figure is mine, not measured. If an order really takes you forty minutes, every number I have given you shrinks. The table shows four volumes so you can find your own row.”*

> **Why that matters:** Leading with your own weak point is the highest-return move in the meeting. It costs you a number you were going to lose anyway under scrutiny, and it buys you the benefit of the doubt on everything you did not volunteer. The alternative is somebody finding it themselves in week three, at which point every other figure you gave them is suspect.

The other three, with short answers

If they say	You say
“What if you leave?”	“Everything is written down and the checks are automatic — they complain the moment anybody breaks one, including someone who has never met me. But also: I am not leaving. That is rather the point.”
“Can we not just hire a temp?”	“A temp types faster. A temp does not check every supplier bill against the order that authorised it. That is the half you cannot hire for.”
“What if it gets something wrong?”	“It refuses rather than guesses. When it is not sure it stops and puts the job in a review list for a person. The failure mode is a queue, not a bad order.”

Say these before they find them

- **It is not plugged into live Sage or the live board yet.** It produces the Sage files correctly and records what it *would* post to the board. Connecting both is what the proposal is for.

- **The 150 checks all pass, but they are my checks.** Stage 1 proves it against Allied's real parts and customers, which is the test that actually counts.
- **Nothing is sent yet.** Dispute letters and purchase orders are written and held, not emailed. That is one small piece of work and it is deliberately off by default.
- **There are no backups yet.** Everything lives in one file on one machine. It is in stage 1 of the proposal for a reason, and it is the only item that could lose data for good.

> **Why that matters:** Saying all three yourself converts them from ammunition into evidence that you are straight with people. Held back, any one of them found later costs you more credibility than all three cost you volunteered.

Running the demo

Reset to clean demo data first:

```
python demo_reset.py
```

Then start the system on **port 8010**. Port 8000 is taken by your other app and the failure is silent — you would be talking to the wrong application, and it looks like you did not prepare.

```
uvicorn app.main:app --port 8010
```

The screens need telling where the system is, or they will look for it on 8000 and show nothing. Put this one line in **frontend/.env.local** once:

```
NEXT_PUBLIC_API_URL=http://127.0.0.1:8010
```

Then start the screens in a second window:

```
cd frontend && npm run dev
```

Demo login (the project's own seeded default):

```
admin@alliedweldingsystems.com  /  AlliedEnterprise2026!
```

> **Before you demo anywhere real**
>
> The demo login is a default that ships with the project and is written down in the setup file. **Change it before this runs on anything that matters** — same for the system's built-in security key. Both are flagged in the setup notes.

The three things to actually show

	Show	Say while it runs
1	**Drop in an order.** Customer resolved, lines matched to the catalogue, split across suppliers, sales order and POs written, packing slip produced	“That was the whole afternoon. It took about a fortieth of a second.”
2	**Drop a bad supplier bill into the Document Reader.** One priced above the PO. Reading it runs the check: it shows the overbilling, holds payment and writes the dispute letter	**This is the demo.** Slow right down. Say: nobody had to remember to check this. Let them read the letter.
3	**Try to break a rule.** A mill cert with a missing reading, or a price quoted off two-month-old steel	“It stops and asks a person. It never guesses.”
4	**Open What Runs By Itself.** Two columns: done for you, and still yours. The held dispute letter from step 2 is sitting in the outbox	“Fourteen minutes an order, down from two hours. And here is exactly what is left and what removes it.”

Do not demo the assistant unless asked

It is the least important part of the system and it invites the conversation you least want — whether the AI can be trusted. Everything touching money or certificates runs on fixed rules with no AI anywhere near it. If it comes up, say exactly that and move on.

Why that matters: An AI demo shifts the room from “does this save us money” to “what happens when it gets it wrong”. You cannot win that second conversation in a meeting, and you do not need to have it, because the answer is that the parts they are worried about never ask a model anything.

The documents, and the order to hand them over

	Document	Give it to
1	**How It Works**	Anyone at Allied. Hand this over first and let them read it before you talk money.
2	**Proposal**	Whoever signs. It has the stages, the payback and the signature block.
3	**What It Costs, and Why**	Whoever challenges the price. You may never need it — having it is the point.

Why that matters: Leading with the proposal makes it a purchase, and purchases get compared, deferred and sent upstairs. Leading with the guide makes it a problem they recognise, and by the time the number appears they have already agreed with the diagnosis. Same documents, different meeting.

Internal pitch notes — Allied Universal Operations Bridge — 24 October 2026. Machine timings measured; the two-hour hand-work baseline is an estimate to confirm with Allied.